Session 3

2025-02-09

1 - Rooftop briefing

~02:00, 23 Marpenoth 1489 DR

1. The party is on the rooftop of the Greenest keep after the dragon's retreat. **Tarbaw Nighthill** is in poor shape from the dragon attack: the half-tended cuts on his face have torn open and are weeping blood through hastily wrapped bandages, his arm hangs in a hastily re-tied sling, and he sways on his feet, visibly fighting to stay upright as he speaks. Every sentence comes shorter than the last.
2. A keep guard arrives with a low-voiced report: cultists are burning the mill, Greenest's main grain stockpile and bakery. Guards will need 15–20 minutes to muster a force. Tarbaw asks the party if they can move faster.
3. Mialee voices the strategic case: *"si esta gente pierde el molino, se va a morir la mitad del pueblo de hambre."* Nuberroca asks for healing supplies before they go; Tarbaw replies that he already gave them three healing potions and that the rest are needed for the wounded from the dragon attack.
4. The party decides to leave by the rehabilitated lower tunnel rather than the front gate, which is less secure. Sinsong and Eguzkilore each put on a cultist robe as disguise.

2 - Approach to the mill

1. Party leaves through the tunnel and works southwest along the river toward the mill. It is the dead of night; some fires elsewhere in town are dying.
2. From cover, the party spots another armed group moving among the houses to the west; they choose to skirt them rather than engage and press on toward the mill.
3. Mialee notices the smoke from the mill is *white*, not the dark colour expected from burning grain or wood. Nyx seconds the observation a moment later. The party files it as suspicious and presses on.
4. Sinsong casts Guidance on Mialee so she can sneak ahead and scout. Mialee creeps in close enough to identify the patrol's composition without being seen: a guard drake, several kobolds, and one leading cultist.
5. As the rest of the party closes in, the drake catches their scent and moves toward them.
6. ***[EPIC]*** Nyx opens with a longbow shot, a critical hit that drops the guard drake in a single arrow. The patrol's dangerous element is gone before the rest can react.
7. Mialee stealthily attacks from cover, killing a kobold in a single hit.
8. Eguzkilore looses an arrow that ends another kobold.
9. Sinsong casts Fire Bolt, ending a distracted kobold before he can react.
10. Amidamaru casts Fire Bolt at the leading cultist, a direct hit that kills him outright.
11. The surviving kobolds break and flee.

3 - The mill ambush

1. From behind a nearby tree, Sinsong uses his magical hand to open the front door while the rest of the party holds ready in case anyone shoots from inside. Nothing happens.
2. Through the open door they see the ground floor: scattered grain sacks, the millstone still grinding, and a pulley system rising to a second level. The mill looks empty; the smoke is coming from upstairs.
3. Eguzkilore enters first; Mia, Nyx, and Amidamaru follow him in quickly, spreading across the ground floor. Sinsong and Nuberroca stay by the doorway.
4. With the party committed inside, the ambush is revealed: a volley of spears and arrows comes down from concealed attackers in the rafters. Two of the throws crit on Eguzkilore, dropping him unconscious. Nyx is hit and badly hurt.
5. Immediately after, ten cultists drop from the rafters into melee, five wearing keep-guard livery.
6. A livery cultist drives a spear under Nyx's armpit, a heavy hit, but she holds.
7. One of the cultists in keep-guard livery steals Eguzkilore's short sword off his unconscious body.
8. Amidamaru casts a cone of flame from his mouth that engulfs four cultists, being careful to spare Nyx from the conflagration. Three cultists die outright in the fire.
9. Mialee shoots from behind a crate, fails the attack, and retreats to safety outdoors.
10. Nuberroca rages forward and engages two livery cultists at the doorway, missing with both attacks. As the cultists land their hits, a *blue glow* runs across each cut and closes it partway.
11. Nyx stabilizes Eguzkilore and downs a healing potion to recover. She's back in fighting shape.
12. Sinsong tries to cast Fire Bolt at one of the cultists, but the spell fumbles, fizzling and sparking in his hand without ever leaving.
13. Recovering quickly from his disappointment, Sinsong leans into his cultist robe disguise: he hugs Amidamaru as if *"arresting"* him, selling the moment to the nearby ambushers. The deception lands hard, and none of the nearby cultists break through it.
14. A livery cultist hits Nyx with his spear, dropping her unconscious. Amidamaru, unaware of his downed friend, attacks the cultist beside him with knives.
15. Sinsong uses his magic to stabilize the halfling.

16. Mid-fight, one of the surviving cultists in keep-guard livery shouts in frustration: *"Mondath no nos dijo que eran tan peligrosos."*
17. Nuberroca finishes a large cultist with a critical Hand Axe blow, sending him flying into the wall.
18. The livery cultist who stole Eguzkilore's short sword breaks for the door and escapes outside the mill. Nuberroca hurls a hand-axe after him at a long distance; the throw hits but does not kill, and the axe lodges in his back as he flees with both the stolen sword and the axe still embedded.
19. Eguzkilore stays down for the rest of the fight, breathing only thanks to Nyx's earlier stabilization, never regaining consciousness on his own.
20. With the last cultist down, the mill falls quiet. The fight inside took just a few minutes.

4 – Looting the cultists

1. The *"fire"* upstairs was a montage: wet straw smoldering, deliberately smoking. The mill itself was never seriously burning. The cultists set the smoke to lure responders into the rafter ambush.
2. Nuberroca claims a piece of green cotton from a cultist's bundle and ties it on as a scarf, praising it as soft as a newborn's skin — he keeps it through the rest of the night.
3. The goliath pockets what he calls a fly in a jar, prizing the unfamiliar curio. Sinsong corrects him — it is a firefly — and Nyx makes the connection out loud, calling it a *lightbulb-head bug*.
4. Nuberroca seizes the framing and presents the jar to Sinsong: *"¡Es un bicho Cabezabombilla como tú!"*
5. The scavenging barbarian scoops up other oddments — sugar from a pouch, a live chicken for the eggs, a dried piece of guano he abandons on sight. Sinsong tries to redirect him to a cow, but the cows are already gone, dead in the streets.
6. A livery cultist's pouch contains a whistle. Nuberroca hands it to Sinsong as a gag, telling him to blow it whenever he wants attention. Sinsong blows it theatrically while discreetly tapping unconscious Eguzkilore with his Healing Staff. His bald head glows from the casting and Eguzkilore wakes; Sinsong sells the whole thing as the whistle's doing.
7. Beyond a few low-quality weapons, the bodies yield two gold bracelets and several art objects worth keeping; Nuberroca also peels a small unfamiliar insignia off one of the corpses and pockets it.
8. Eguzkilore checks the second floor: flour bags and grain sacks, plus the millstone's clutch, which they disengage to stop the grinding.
9. With the mill secured in the hands of the recently arrived guards, the party heads back to the keep through the tunnel.

5 – Keep under attack

~03:00, 23 Marpenoth 1489 DR

1. The lower tunnel is unusually silent. Combat noise from deeper in the keep reveals enemies have entered through another route.
2. Party emerges into the keep's inner courtyard: the sally port gate has been breached. Cultists, kobolds, and drakes are fighting the guards across the courtyard; six attackers head for the heroes on sight.
3. Sinsong removes the cultist robe and elbows Eguzkilore to do the same before joining the fight.
4. Sinsong takes cover behind the well; Mia crouches behind a wagon. Nuberroca, ignoring cover entirely, charges straight in.
5. Eguzkilore drops a cultist with a clean longbow shot to the eye.
6. Sinsong casts Fire Bolt repeatedly from behind the well, ducking after each cast. One cultist's shield deflects the first bolt entirely.
7. Mialee hides and shoots each round; she remains effectively undetected through the entire fight.
8. Nuberroca grapples a livery cultist and **throws him head-first down the well**, the cultist's head bouncing audibly off the stone walls all the way down.
9. As cultists land hits on Nuberroca during the courtyard melee, a *blue glow* runs across each cut and closes the wound.
10. Two livery cultists trip over each other trying to flank Nuberroca and are hacked down. The remaining cultists try to escape; only one makes it through the sally port, the rest fall.
11. Among the felled, one kobold lies stunned but breathing. Nyx calls to keep it alive. Nuberroca binds and gags it on the spot and stows it against a courtyard wall for later questioning.

6 - The sally port room

1. Mialee splits off to scout the sally port room, vanishing from the group's sight; from the other side of the door the rest of the party hears the unmistakable rhythm of a four-volley salvo — the cultists inside the room overwhelm her in a brutal assault, leaving her unconscious on the chamber floor.
2. Sinsong opens the chamber door from afar using Mage Hand while Nyx, Eguzkilore, and Nuberroca ready weapons.
3. Through the open door the party gets its first look inside: a small chamber holding two cultist acolytes, several kobolds, and another large drake — with Mialee's unconscious body on the floor in the middle of them.
4. Nuberroca, seeing the unconscious little Mia on the floor, charges in Raging with a hand-axe.
5. An acolyte casts Command on Nuberroca; Nuberroca shrugs it off. The other acolyte buffs himself with a defensive ward.
6. Nyx, briefly dissuaded by the acolyte's defensive ward, shakes it off and lands a chest-shot on the caster, dropping him.
7. Sinsong casts Spare the Dying on Mialee from across the room, stabilizing her.
8. The lead acolyte Commands Nuberroca to disarm; the goliath drops his weapons. The drake and a kobold attack together; the kobold critically wounds the barbarian, dropping him unconscious.
9. Sinsong tries to throw a Fire Bolt at a nearby enemy; the spell fizzles in his hand and he ducks back.
10. Unable to cast more Commands, the acolyte falls back on Sacred Flame and starts sweeping the room turn after turn — Sinsong takes the first flare and resists, his bald head briefly glowing; Eguzkilore weathers the next without yielding.
11. Sinsong moves close to Nuberroca and uses his magic to stabilize him.
12. The drake rounds on Sinsong, connecting a bite that drops him *beside Nuberroca*.
13. Eguzkilore takes another Sacred Flame, then digs deep and pushes through the worst of the damage, staying on his feet. Nyx flanks the drake and stabs it until it stops moving.
14. Eguzkilore reaches Sinsong and patches the worst of his wounds, stabilizing the cleric.
15. Amidamaru kills the last kobold with a Fire Bolt.
16. The acolyte tries Sacred Flame again, aimed at Nyx; it fizzles harmlessly. With his colleague dead, the kobolds gone, and the rest of the party closing on him, he turns and flees out the broken sally port.
17. With the raiders repelled, the heroes focus on healing their wounded: Mialee, Nuberroca, and Sinsong are unconscious but stable; the rest of the party is heavily wounded.

7 - Sally port repair

~04:00, 23 Marpenoth 1489 DR

1. Nyx rummages Nuberroca's pack, finds his unused healing potions among the plethora of items collected, and force-feeds one to him and one to Sinsong; both revive instantly, feeling much better.
2. Sinsong stands up and blows the whistle theatrically while discreetly tapping Mialee with his Healing Staff, his bald head glowing as Mialee wakes. The whistle gag holds.
3. Mia wakes recounting a nightmare, disoriented; the trauma from the sally-port room sits heavy on her without being named aloud.
4. Nuberroca crouches over the bound courtyard kobold and presses it for intel. Through fear and broken Common, the only useful thing it gives up: a *"dragon woman"* gave their orders — raid Greenest and the surrounding villages and take as much loot as they can carry. The kobold's untreated wounds catch up with it, and it bleeds out where it sits before they can press it further.
5. Amidamaru repairs the sally port door using his Artificer tools to put the broken structure back together over ~10 minutes, while Eguzkilore arranges a barricade of furniture as backup.
6. The keep guards confirm the assault is breaking. Most attackers are leaving Greenest. The party tries to sleep, but soldiers are still mopping up the last attackers across town and another wave cannot be ruled out, so they simply rest a bit.
7. During the short rest the party studies a recovered cult map. They see Greenest clearly labeled, with several other locations also highlighted; most notably an X southeast of Greenest.
8. The hour proves *unexpectedly restorative*. The party comes out healed and refreshed, ready to continue their adventure.

8 - The challenge

~05:00, 23 Marpenoth 1489 DR

1. A large, hooded figure (~7 ft) stands at the gate with 10 kobolds and three civilian prisoners: a woman and two boys, knives at their throats. The figure's voice is deep and dragonborn.
2. The figure addresses the keep:
   "Defensores de Greenest, esta ha sido una noche exitosa y me siento generoso. ¿Veis estos tres vergonzosos e inútiles prisioneros? No los necesitamos, así que acepto devolvéroslos. Mandadnos a vuestro mejor guerrero a luchar contra mí y podréis tener a estos tres en respuesta."
3. The three prisoners are recognised as the family of a keep guard: his sister and two nephews, taken from the town during the assault and held hostage.
4. The guard is **Sergeant Markguth**, who steps forward at the wall when he sees them, recognising his family.
5. **Tarbaw**, beside Nuberroca, quietly notes that none of his soldiers would stand a chance and asks whether one of the party would go in their place.
6. Nyx asks if the figure is acting in good faith, and the figure swears on his honour.
7. Nuberroca accepts the challenge and asks the figure what becomes of the prisoners.
8. The figure responds with his terms, declaring his word worth more than their lives, and lays out the duel: whoever dies, the prisoners go free; the outcome of the combat does not matter to him, only the fun of the fight.
9. Nuberroca requests healing before stepping out. A guard hands him one of the last full healing potions. Sinsong runs the whistle gag, blowing it theatrically while tapping Nuberroca with the Healing Staff. The potion goes down with unusual force, the brew turns more potent than usual. Nuberroca steps out reinvigorated.
10. ***[EPIC]*** Nuberroca removes the green cotton scarf, folds it carefully, sets it on the ground, then stomps once and announces:
    "Soy Nuberroca Quebrantacielos, guardián del paso sagrado y escudo del árbol del mundo. No lucho por gloria ni oro, sino por el deber. Si buscas desafiarme, que los espíritus de la montaña sean testigos de tu destino."
11. The figure pulls back its hood and cloak: a blue dragonborn with greatsword, lance and the build of a champion. He responds:
    *"Yo soy **Langdedrosa Cyanwrath**, y estoy aquí para grabar mi nombre en la historia de este pueblo."*
12. On Langdedrosa's signal, the two boys are released; they run to the keep gate and are taken inside. The mother remains in kobold custody, knife at throat.

9 - The duel

1. Both fighters stand 50 feet apart on either side of the open gate. Mialee, Sinsong, Eguzkilore, Nyx, and the keep watchers line the wall, weapons sheathed by **Langdedrosa**'s terms.
2. Nuberroca opens by hurling a hand-axe; the throw goes wide at the distance. Langdedrosa surges forward and hurls his lance at the barbarian, hitting hard.
3. Nuberroca lets the fury take him. He closes and attacks twice with two hand-axes; both land cleanly. The *blue glow* flares again across his older cuts.
4. Langdedrosa plants his greatsword in the ground and exhales a lightning breath in a line. Nuberroca dives aside and catches the brunt at a glancing angle, but the lightning still takes a heavy toll.
5. Nuberroca closes again, pushes through with hand-axes, both hit. Langdedrosa is visibly bloodied and stops smiling.
6. Langdedrosa raises his greatsword and swings four times in the same breath. The first hits Nuberroca and leaves him *barely standing*. The second misses. The third misses. The fourth lands cleanly. Nuberroca falls unconscious.
7. Langdedrosa stalks forward, plunges his greatsword into Nuberroca's abdomen and twists. He withdraws and turns to leave; Nuberroca is unconscious, his life slowly fading away.
8. Sinsong, near the wall, raises his hands to cast Fire Bolt at the retreating Langdedrosa. Eguzkilore and the others restrain Sinsong physically, warning that any retaliation would mean Nuberroca died for nothing; Sinsong relents and instead runs to cast Spare the Dying on the unconscious goliath, keeping him alive on the ground.
9. Langdedrosa keeps his word. As he withdraws, he walks into his own kobold ranks, frees the woman from her captor, and disappears with the rest of his force into the night.

10 – Aftermath

1. The raiding army is leaving, victorious; the assault is over.
2. Nuberroca, stabilized by the party cleric, is back on his feet shortly after.
3. **Tarbaw** offers the party two more healing potions and 60 gp total, 10 for each of them, for the night's defence and for rescuing the guard's family.
4. The party shows Tarbaw the items they recovered from the raiders: two gold bracelets and several art objects. They identify these as belongings of Greenest townsfolk and return them to the keep for the families. Nuberroca leads this, framing it as paying back their humble hosts before they leave.
5. Tarbaw praises the party's honourable acts: defending Greenest and returning the recovered townsfolk goods rather than keeping them.
6. The party pools their gold to clear Sinsong's resurrection debt. The cleric forgives 100 gp as a token of gratitude; the guards contribute another 100 gp; the party covers the remaining 400 gp with their combined funds.
7. Nuberroca produces the cultist insignia he pocketed back at the mill. The party recognises it through general lore: it is the symbol of **Tiamat**, the five-headed dragon goddess. The raiders are confirmed to be the *Cult of the Dragon*.
8. The party retires to the barracks to rest, sleeping until well past the morning.